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SUPERSEDING
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13 August 1979

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

INSIGNIA; BRANCH OF SERVICE, GRADE, RANK, GARRISON CAP, AND SERVICE CAP, ROTC AND JROTC PERSONNEL, ARMY AND AIR FORCE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the general requirements for the branch of service insignia, metal rank insignia, garrison cap insignia and service cap insignia for Army and Air Force ROTC and JROTC personnel.

1.2 Classification. Insignia covered herein shall be as specified in the applicable military specification sheet (see 2.1 and 6.2).

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications and standards. The following specifications and standards form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

QQ-N-290 - Nickel Plating, Electrodeposited
QQ-S-365 - Silver Plating, Electrodeposited, General Requirements for
QQ-Z-363 - Zinc base alloy, die castings
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: Director, The Institute of Heraldry, US Army, Cameron Station, Alexandria, VA 22304-5050, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 8455

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MILITARY

MIL-F-495 - Finish, Chemical, Black for Copper Alloys

(See supplement 1 for list of associated specifications)

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-151 - Metal, Test Methods
FED-STD-406 - Plastics: Methods of Testing

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues shall be those in effect on the date of the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

B-2-36 - Molded Plastic Backing, USAF ROTC Jr. Div., Cap Insignia
B-2-36A - Molded Plastic Backing, USAF ROTC Jr. Div., Lapel and Grade Insignia
B-13-12 - Attaching Devices for Heraldic Prong and Clutch Type

STANDARD

THE INSTITUTE OF HERALDRY

Standard color chip set

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and specification sheets required by the contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer).

(Figures 3, 4 and 5 are miniature copies of the referenced drawings and are for information only).

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2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted shall be those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS shall be the issue of the nongovernment documents which is current on the date of the solicitation.

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS

ASTM-B- 487 - Method for Measurement of Metal and Oxide Coating Thickness by Microscopical Examination of a Cross Section.
ASTM-D-3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging.

(Application for copies of ASTM publications should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19103.)

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations which prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this specification and the references cited herein, (except for associated detail specifications, specification sheets or MS standards) the text of this specification shall take precedence. Nothing in this specification, however, shall supersede applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Specification sheets. The individual item requirements shall be as specified herein and in accordance with the applicable specification sheets. In the event of any conflict between requirements of this specification and the specification sheets, the latter shall govern.

3.2 Detail requirements for individual medals. The detail requirements or exceptions for a particular medal shall be as specified on the applicable specification sheet. In the event of conflict between this specification and the applicable specification sheet the latter shall govern. The design of the medal shown on the specification sheets are for illustrative purposes only, the design is controlled by the Government furnished hub (see 3.10).

3.3 Standard sample. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the contracting officer will furnish a standard sample for matching color and finish only.

3.4 First article. When specified in the contract or purchase order, a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 4.3 and 6.4)

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3.5 Materials. Materials shall conform to the referenced specifications and the requirements specified herein.

3.5.1 Copper base alloy. Copper base alloys shall be roll polished, free from pits, scale (including red oxide), dents, cracks, nicks, deep scratches, segregations and foreign matter that will not be removed by processing. The chemical composition of the applicable copper base alloys shall be as shown in table I, when tested as specified in 4.6.1.

TABLE I. Chemical composition of copper base alloys.

Alloy	Copper	Nickel 1/	Lead (Maximum)	Iron (Maximum)	Manganese (Maximum)	Zinc	Others (Maximum)
Red brass	84.0-86.0		.05	.05		Remainder	.15
Bronze	89.0-91.0		.05	.05		Remainder	.13
Yellow brass	64.0-68.5		.15	.05		Remainder	.15
Gilding metal	94.0-96.0		.04	.05		Remainder	.13
Nickel silver	63.0-66.5 2/	16.5-19.5	.10	.25	.50	Remainder	

1/ Cobalt counting as nickel.
2/ Copper content for use in pin only may be 53.5 to 56.5 percent.

3.5.1.1 Zinc aluminum alloy. The zinc aluminum alloy used for die casting shall conform to alloy AG40A or AC41A or QQ-Z-363.

3.5.2 Silver for plating. The silver for plating shall be not less than 99.5 percent fine.

3.5.3 Solder. Solder shall be a silver alloy having a melting point of not less than 1065 degrees F.

3.5.4 Lacquer. Lacquer shall be a pale clear synthetic lacquer. The use of pigmented lacquers shall not be permitted.

3.5.5 Vitreous enamel. Vitreous enamel shall be a hard, glass type enamel fused with metallic oxides to produce the desired shade and opacity or translucence.

3.5.6 Baking enamel. The enamel for Army subdued insignia of grade/rank and branch of service shall be a flat black synthetic baking enamel.

3.5.7 Plastic. The plastic for the backing plates shall be a virgin plastic material except that cellulose nitrate or cellulose acetate butyrate shall not be used. The plastic shall have a white opaque color and shall match the color of the standard (see 4.5.3.1 and 4.6.9).

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3.5.8 Gold for plating. Gold for plating shall be 24 karat.

3.6 Design. The embossed design of the metal insignia shall be exact duplicate of the designs on the Government loaned hubs (see 3.10), from which the contractor's working dies or die molds shall be extracted. The contractor's dies or die molds shall be tooled and polished to remove any dents, nicks, scratches or other imperfections.

3.7 Construction. Regular and miniature insignia shall be stamped from red brass.

3.7.1 Stamping, trimming and piercing. The stamping shall have a well defined die struck edge. The insignia shall be trimmed and when applicable pierced to the die struck outline. All edges shall be clean, smooth and free from burrs, drag, step and rough edges. The stamping, trimming and piercing operation shall not damage or distort the design or alter the shape of the insignia.

3.7.2 Soldering or electronic fusion. Joints shall be soldered using solder specified in 3.5.3, or electronically fused. All soldered joints shall be completely joined without excess solder and all excess flux shall be removed. There shall be no burned or reduced areas and all joints shall be strong and smooth. When tested as specified in 4.6.3, the soldered joints shall not crack or separate. When tested as specified in 4.6.5, the prongs shall not separate from the badge at the fused joint.

3.7.3 Forcer. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, the use of a forcer to bring up the design of the insignia shall not be permitted. When a forcer is permitted, only a mock forcer will be used. The forced area shall be regular and symmetrical with the design on the front of the insignia. There shall be no sharp or rough edges formed by the forcing operation.

3.7.4 Molding. The plastic backing plates shall be molded in accordance with the details and dimensions of drawing B-2-36 or B-2-36A, as applicable. Knockout pin marks and break-of marks shall not be located in areas which are normally visible when in actual use. All marks shall be flush with or below adjacent areas and shall be without sharp edges.

3.7.5 Stability. When tested as specified in 4.6.6, the backing plate shall not twist, chip, crack, break, or blister and shall be free from warp so when the backing plate is placed on a surface plate with the beveled edge upward, at least 75 percent of the perimeter of the disk shall be in contact with the plate and there shall be no gap exceeding 1/32 of an inch.

3.7.5.1 Water absorption. When tested as specified in 4.6.7 the water absorption shall not be greater than 2.5 percent.

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3.8 Attaching device. The attaching device shall be prong and clutch or screwpost and registering prong as specified on the applicable specification sheet and as specified herein.

3.8.1 Rivets. Rivets used for attaching superimposed device to the front of the base shall be solid or tubular and shall be made from any type brass. Rivets shall be securely peened or swaged to insure a tight and close fit between the component parts. At the option of the manufacturer, rivets may be soldered to, or be an integral part of the device.

3.8.2 Prong and clutch type. Prongs and clutches shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on Drawing B-13-12. Unless otherwise specified, the prongs shall be soldered or fused in the location specified on the applicable specification sheet. Unless otherwise specified, the prongs shall be made from nickel silver specified in 3.5.1 and shall be 5/16 inch plus or minus 1/64 inch in length. Clutches shall be made from any type brass. When tested as specified in 4.6.2 and 4.6.12, it shall not be possible to remove the clutch by hand without first depressing the release wings.

3.8.3 Screw post and thumb nut. The screwpost and thumb nut shall conform to the details and dimensions shown on figure 2. The screw post shall be soldered or fused in the location specified in the applicable specification sheet. The screwpost and thumb nut shall be made from free cutting brass. When tested as specified in 4.6.9 the thumb nut shall not bind on the thread.

3.8.4 Registering prong. The registering prong shall be made from nickel silver specified in 3.5.1 and shall conform to the details and dimensions specified on figure 2. The prong shall be soldered or fused in location specified on the applicable specification sheet. When tested as specified in 4.6.3 and 4.6.5, the registering prong shall not separate at the soldered or fused joint.

3.9 Finish. Unless otherwise specified, the front and edges (surfaces visible from the front) shall be finished as specified on the applicable specification sheet and shall match the color and finish of the standard sample (see 3.3) or the approved guide sample (see 3.4). Where plating or oxidizing is specified the entire item (front, back and edges) except for the attaching devices, shall be plated or oxidized as applicable. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet the backs of all oxidized items shall be clean. In addition to the finish specified on the specification sheets, all items, except gold or rhodium plated items shall be completely coated with lacquer specified in 3.5.4. The finish for molded plastic backing plates shall be smooth and the beveled sections shall have a high uniform luster as provided by the molding. A high luster is not required for other areas. (When the term "clean" is used, the referenced areas need not be free from oxidization. However, any oxidization remaining must have a consistent uniform shade and texture).

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3.9.1 Lacquering. The dry lacquer film shall be continuous, level, adherent and free from lint, dust or other foreign matter. When tested as specified in 4.6.4.1, there shall be no change in appearance on the face of the item except a slight overall yellowing around the highlights. When tested as specified in 4.6.4.2, the tissue paper shall not adhere to the insignia when the pressure is released.

3.9.2 Silver plating. Silver plating shall be accomplished by electroplating methods using the silver specified in 3.5.2. Prior to plating, the surface to be plated shall be cleaned of all matter which would affect the plating. Copper based alloy items shall be hot nickel underplated, a minimum of 0.00025 inch thick. If the copper based alloys used is nickel silver, the use of nickel underplating shall be optional. Silver filled items shall not be underplated. The silver plating shall be a minimum of 0.0003 inch thick and shall be smooth, fine grained, adherent, free from visible blisters, pits, porosity, indications of excessive build up or other defects. Nickel underplating thickness shall be tested on the obverse side only in accordance with Std. Comm'l. Items made of silver filled material shall be tested on the reverse side for compliance with the silver plating thickness requirement and items made of brass shall be silver thickness tested on the obverse side.

3.9.3 Gold plating. Plating shall be accomplished using gold specified in 3.5.8. Prior to plating, all surfaces shall be cleaned of all matter which might affect the gold plating. The plating shall be non-porous and continuous over the entire plate surface. There shall be no cut-through, peeled or blistered plating. The use of white metal as an undercoating shall not be permitted. When tested as specified in 4.6.8, there shall be no visible chemical reactions, such as evolution of gases shall appear.

3.9.4 Rhodium plating. When rhodium plating is specified, an undercoating of nickel will be required. The rhodium plating shall be continuous and adherent over the entire plated surface. There shall be no cut-through or areas of shaded, peeled or blistered plating. When tested as specified in 4.6.8, no visible chemical reaction shall occur.

3.9.5 Subdued insignia. The face and edges of all subdued insignia shall be coated with enamel specified in 3.5.6. Prior to enameling, the entire insignia shall be given a black chemical finish conforming to MIL-F-495. When the subdued insignia is die cast from zinc aluminum specified in 3.5.1.1, the insignia shall be copper plated. When tested as specified in 4.6.13. The plating shall be a minimum of 0.0003 inch thick. When tested as specified in 4.6.10 and 4.6.11, the enamel shall not flake or chip and no color shall transfer to the cotton except for a slight trace of residue. Either stamping or die casting methods of manufacturing shall be acceptable for subdued insignia. When the die cast method is used, the insignia shall be free from porosity, blow holes or other casting defects. Before finishing, all flash lines shall be removed and the edges of the insignia shall be smooth. Unless otherwise specified on the applicable specification sheet, a tolerance of plus

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or minus 0.005 inch will be allowed on all interior dimensions. As an alternate of construction, prongs may be cast as an integral part of the insignia. When this method of construction is utilized, the prong shall be tested as specified in paragraph 4.6.12 and no evidence of breaking or cracking shall occur.

3.9.6 Dimensions. All dimensions shall be as indicated. When reference dimensions are given, these dimensions are furnished as information for bidding purposes only. The actual dimensions will be controlled by the Government loaned hub.

3.9.7 Cutting down. When necessary to remove nicks, scratches, pin holes or other blemishes, the pendant shall be cut down by means of grease or oil buffing. The pendant shall not be cut down to the extent that any details of the design are obliterated or reduced.

3.10 Government loaned property. Hubs will be loaned by the Government and shall be used for making the contractor's working dies or molds necessary for one contract or order (see 6.2).

3.11 Marking. For Government procurements the contractor shall stamp his identification mark and the letters "GI" legibly and inconspicuously on the back or back bar of each insignia.

4.12 Workmanship. The finished insignia shall be clean, well made and shall meet the acceptable quality level established by this specification.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of assuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling in quality conformance does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to acceptance of defective material.

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4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).

b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.3 Inspection conditions. Unless otherwise specified, all inspections shall be performed in accordance with the test conditions specified in 4.5 and 4.6 in this specification.

4.4 First article inspection. Inspection and testing of the first article shall be made on a completely finished item for all provisions of this specification applicable to end product examination and tests.

4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.5.1 Inspection of components.

4.5.1.1 Testing of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions of the subsidiary specifications and drawings, inspection shall be performed on components and materials listed in table II for the test characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the requirements are applicable to lot average.

TABLE II. Component testing.

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Rqm't para	Test method	Rqmt appl. to lot avg.	#determ per sample unit	Results reported as	Sample unit
Copper base alloys, as applicable (1 pound)	Chemical composition	3.5.1 and table I	Method 111 of Fed Std No. 151	x	2 for each element (Com posite)	To near-est 0.1%	One 4x4 sheet or equiv-alent for each alloy

4.5.1.2 Certification of compliance. Components and materials listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certification of compliance for requirements specified in the applicable paragraphs of this specification.

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Component	Characteristic	Rqm't para.
Gold (for plating)	Karat and underplating	3.5.8 and 3.9.3
Silver (for plating)	Fineness	3.5.2
Solder	Material identification	3.5.3
Lacquer	Material identification and absence of pigmentation	3.5.4
Attaching devices (Prong and clutch, registering prong, screwpost and thumb nut,	Material identification and temper	3.8 or applicable specification sheet
Plastic (molding)	Material identification	3.5.7
Enamel	Material identification	3.5.5

4.5.2 In-progress inspection. Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operation or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements:

Operation	Characteristic	Rqm't para.
Hot nickel plating	Used as underplating	3.9.2 and 3.9.4

4.5.2.1 Testing of intermediate product. Insignia shall be tested for copper plating thickness in accordance with 4.6.13. There shall be two determinations per sample unit and the results shall be reported to the nearest 0.0001 inch. The sample unit shall be one plated insignia (from each plating batch) of one type. The thickness of nickel plated insignia shall be tested in accordance with standard commercial practice. There shall be one determination per sample unit and results shall be reported as pass or fail. The sample unit shall be one insignia. The requirement is applicable to the individual unit, the inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units. In the event of dispute, the test method shall be ASTM method B487.

4.5.3 Inspection of the end item.

4.5.3.1 Visual inspection of insignia. Examination shall be made at a distance of approximately 16 to 22 inches. The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.5.3.1.1 and 4.5.3.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.5.3.1.3. The unit of product for the examinations in 4.5.3.1.1 and 4.5.3.1.2 shall be one completely fabricated insignia or plastic backing plate, as applicable.

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4.5.3.1.1 Examination of insignia for defects in finish, design, material, construction, workmanship and marking. Defects designated by an asterisk (*) shall be classified as major when seriously affecting serviceability or appearance and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

Examine	Defect	Classification		
			Major (*)	Minor
Metal insignia				
Front:				
Color and finish	Poor match to the approved guide sample e.g., does not match the approved guide sample as follows:			
	The oxidized finish, when required, has not been sufficiently relieved or has been excessively relieved	-	*	-
	Is not highlighted to the same extent as the approved guide sample; or is excessively highlighted	-	*	-
	Foreign matter embedded.	-	*	-
	Surface contains pits, scale, nick scratch, crack, machine mark	-	*	-
	Pinhole, rupture, segregation or other blemish	-	*	-
	Buff, drag, blushed or cloudy finish, discolored, i.e., spot, stain or speck	-	*	-
	Not clean.	-	*	-
Plating	Not plated (when required)	x	-	-
	Not type specified	x	-	-
	Plating is not smooth, not continuous or not adherent.	x	-	-
	Cut-through or porous.	x	-	-
Enamel	Not enameled (when required)	x	-	-
	Wrong color.	x	-	-
	Wrong shade.	x	-	-
	Cracked, chipped, or crazed.	-	*	-
	Bubbles, lumps, or foreign inclusion	-	*	-
	Not stoned smooth (when required), e.g., is coarse or uneven.	-	*	-
	Is not level with the dikes, e.g., contains high or low spots	-	*	-
	Hole or blister.	-	*	-
	Laps, overruns, or skips	-	*	-
	Fishscale, copperheads, burnoffs, scale, specking, discoloration, scumming, or lack of gloss	-	*	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification Major	(*)	Minor
Lacquering	Not lacquered (when required).	x	-	-
	Lacquer forms noticeable runs or contains sharp coarse particles.	-	*	-
	Coating is not smooth and adherent, e.g., is flaking, blistering, or peeling.	-	*	-
Design	Detail altered and does not conform to Government hub.	x	-	-
	Any warp, twist or distortion producing irregular surface contour or outline.	-	*	-
	Any significant detail obliterated or reduced.	x	-	-
	Detail struck over, resulting in a double impression.	x	-	-
	Not as specified	x	-	-
Quality of metal	Surface pitted, porous, crystalline spotted or opened grained	x	-	-
Construction and workmanship	Any component missing, twisted, bent out of shape, malformed or deformed	x	-	-
	Not connected or joined as specified, or operation is poorly accomplished.	x	-	-
	Not trimmed to the die struck edge	-	*	-
	Not pierced where required	x	-	-
	Piercing not clean and smooth, e.g., any burrs, cutter drill or file marks	-	*	-
	Design or shape altered by piercing.	-	*	-
	Any rough or ragged edge, drag or step	-	*	-
	Any solder spatter on front, exposed or concealed by plating.	x	-	-
Cleanness	Spatter or discoloration on edge 3/32 inch in length	x	-	-
	Spatter or discoloration on edge less than 3/32 inch in length clearly noticeable. . . .	-	*	-
Plastic backing plate				
Front:				
Color and finish	Not smooth and not uniform shade	-	*	-
	Color and opacity poor match to standard guide sample.	x	-	-
	Bevel section does not have uniform luster . .	-	*	-
	Any foreign matter embedded.	-	*	-
	Any crack, blister, break, lump, pit, crater or other imperfection clearly noticeable. . .	x	-	-
	Any scratch on the beveled surface	-	*	-
Design	Not in accordance with figure 3 or 4, as applicable.	x	-	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
Workmanship	Any chip, nick, dent, dig, gouge, flash, fin or burr clearly noticeable.	x	-	-
	Any warp, twist, unevenness, or distortion . .	x	-	-
	Any hole not formed as indicated by the drawing	x	-	-
	Breakoff mark not neatly accomplished, i.e., sharp or rough projection which is clearly noticeable.	x	-	-
Metal insignia				
Back and edges:				
Color and finish	Not clean.	-	*	-
	Pit, scale, nick, crack, machine mark, pinhole, rupture, segregation or other blemish	-	-	x
	Buff, drag, blushed or cloudy finish	-	-	x
	Foreign matter embedded, affecting appearance.	-	-	x
	Discoloration, spot or stain affecting appearance.	-	-	x
Plating	Not plated when required	x	-	-
	Not type specified	x	-	-
	Plating is not continuous, is cut through, porous, or is not adherent.	x	-	-
Lacquering	Coating is not adherent, e.g., is blistered, flaking or peeling.	-	*	-
Chemical finish	Not chemically finished (subdued only)	x	-	-
	Not type of chemical finish specified (subdued only).	-	-	x
	Chemical finish is not continuous over the entire insignia (subdued only).	x	-	-
Fastening device(metal)	Fastening device not specified type, size or material	x	-	-
	Any component missing.	x	-	-
	Defective, e.g., any part damaged or malformed affecting use	-	*	-
	Prongs or post not perpendicular to the back of the insignia	-	*	-
	Not positioned as specified, or component off center by 1/8 inch or more.	-	*	-
	Clutch will not engage prong, or is loose fit.	x	-	-
	Prong is loose	x	-	-
	Prong is bent out of shape, or is otherwise impaired.	-	*	-
	Threads on post and nut are stripped, crossed, damaged or not specified size, fit, or type	-	*	-

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Examine	Defect	Classification		
		Major	(*)	Minor
Workmanship	Back not flat or smooth when required.	-	-	x
	Edges are not clean and smooth	-	-	x
	Any sharp or rough edge, burr, drag or step. .	-	*	-
	Component parts are not completely joined by solder.	-	*	-
	Any area burned or reduced in soldering or acid cleaning	-	*	-
	Any solder spatter exceeding 3/16 inch in maximum dimension	-	*	-
	Flux or excess solder not removed.	-	-	x
	Not connected or joined as specified or operation is poorly accomplished.	-	*	-
	Edges of forced area are not clean or smooth, when applicable	-	-	x
Plastic Backing plates (back)	Any foreign matter embedded.	-	-	x
	Breakoff mark not neatly accomplished which could abrade cloth material	x	-	-
Marking	Missing, incorrect, illegible, misspelled, not accomplished as specified or not placed as specified.	-	-	x

4.5.3.1.2 Examination of insignia for defects in dimensions. Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerance shall be classified a defect.

4.5.3.1.3 Inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's). The inspection levels and the acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defects per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For examinations applicable to 4.5.3.1.1	II	2.5	10.0
For examinations applicable to 4.5.3.1.2	S-1	(one class)	6.5

4.5.3.2 Testing of the end item. Testing of the completely fabricated insignia shall be performed in accordance with table III for the characteristics shown therein. The sample unit for end item testing, except for fused prongs, shall be three completely fabricated insignia for each rank and size; for fused prongs the sample unit shall be one insignia. Silver thickness shall be tested on the reverse side. The requirements are applicable to the individual unit and except for fused prong testing, with one determination per

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sample unit. For fused prongs, all prongs on that item will be tested, however, one defect will be scored regardless of how many prongs on that item fails. The results shall be reported as pass or fail. Except for fused prong testing, the inspection shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units; for fused prong testing, the inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 6.5 defects per hundred units.

TABLE III. End item testing.

Characteristic in terms of	Rqm't para.	Test method	#determ per s/u	Results reported as
Metal insignia:				
Test for fused joint	3.7.2	4.6.5	1 (all prongs on each sample)	Pass or fail
Test for screw posts and nuts/plates	3.8.2	4.6.9	1	Pass or fail
Test for soldered joint	3.7.2	4.6.3	1	Pass or fail
Test for prong & clutch	3.8.1	4.6.2	1	Pass or fail
Lacquer tests:				
Liver of sulfur	3.9.1	4.6.4.1	1	Pass or fail
Tackiness	3.9.1	4.6.4.2	1	Pass or fail
Acid test for gold	3.9.3 and	4.6.8	1	Pass or fail
or rhodium plating	3.9.4		1	Pass or fail
Nickel plating thickness	3.9.2	Std Comm'l 1/	1	Pass or fail
Silver plating thickness	3.9.2	Std Comm'l 2/	1	Pass or fail
Copper plating thickness	3.9.5	4.6.3	1	Pass or fail
Test for baked enamel film	3.9.5	4.6.10 and 4.6.11	-	Pass or fail
Backing plates:				
Stability	3.7.5	4.6.6	1	Pass or fail
Water absorption	3.7.5.1	4.6.7	1	Pass or fail
Test for integral prongs	3.9.5	4.6.12	*	Pass or fail

* When applicable insignia are to be tested in each sample unit 2 prongs per insignia.

1/ In event of dispute; the testing method shall be ASTM-B-487.
2/ In the event of dispute, the test method shall be Test Method 521.1 of FED-STD-151.

4.5.4 Examination for count of insignia in intermediate containers. Insignia packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (interior package). Any box containing less than the specified or marked quantity of insignia shall be classified as a defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers.

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4.5.5 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are compiled with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed below shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examination	Defect
Markings (Exterior and interior)	Missing, incorrect, illegible, of improper size, location, sequence or method of application.
Materials	Component missing damaged or otherwise defective, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of envelope and container flaps, insecure seating of fastening device, tissue wrapping incomplete, voids inadequately filled and bulging or distortion of containers.
Weight	Net weight exceeds requirements.

4.5.6 Palletization examination. An examination shall be made to determine that the palletization is in compliance with the section 5 requirements. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load fully packaged. The lot size shall be the number of palletized unit loads in the inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 6.5.

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirements.
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified. Interlocking of loads not as specified. Load not bonded with required straps as specified.
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits.
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

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4.6 Tests.

4.6.1 Chemical composition test. Chemical composition shall be determined in accordance with method number 111 of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.5.1.

4.6.2 Test for clutch type attaching device. The clutches shall be removed and replaced ten times from the prong. An attempt shall then be made to remove the clutch by hand without first depressing the release wings, during which time the clutch and prong shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.8.1.

4.6.3 Test for hard soldered joints. Hard soldered items shall be placed in an oven maintained at 1065 degrees F. plus or minus 5 degrees F. for 15 minutes. While at this temperature the item shall be lifted by the attaching device and shall be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.7.2.

4.6.4 Test for lacquer.

4.6.4.1 Liver of sulfur test. All insignia to be tested, except rhodium plated or gold plated items, shall be immersed in 2 percent by weight CP liver of sulfur (sulfated potash) water solution at a temperature of 100 degrees F. plus or minus 10 degrees F. for a period of three minutes. The item shall then be removed and rinsed in warm, then cold, then hot water. The item shall be wiped gently with an absorbent cellulose material or whirled to remove residual moisture and shall be air dried at room temperature (60 degrees F to 80 degrees F.) for one hour. The item shall then be inspected to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.9.1.

4.6.4.2 Tackiness test. At room temperature (60 degrees F. to 80 degrees F.) press a piece of tissue paper against the lacquered surface for 15 seconds using any pressure capable of being exerted between the thumb and two fingers, after which the pressure shall be released and the item inspected to determine compliance with the requirements of 3.9.1.

4.6.5 Test for electronically fused joints. Item to be tested shall be anchored on a horizontal surface. All prongs on each end item shall be grasped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint and bent thru an angle of 90 degrees (45 degrees to each side of the vertical) until separation occurs. The fused joint shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.2. A bending tool in the form of a 45 degree template may be used for this test provided the prong is gripped at least 1/3 its length above the fused joint.

4.6.6 Stability at high temperature and humidity. The disk shall be tested in accordance with method 6011, procedure III of FED-STD-406, and shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.5.

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4.6.7 Test for water absorption. The disk shall be tested in accordance with method 7031, procedure A of FED-STD-406 and shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.7.5.1. Dimensional changes in the disk shall be considered and reported.

4.6.8 Acid test for gold or rhodium plating. Insignia to be tested for compliance with 3.9.3 and 3.9.4 may be unlacquered or have the lacquered completely removed with an organic solvent. The acid test shall be conducted as follows using a solution containing 50 percent by volume of CP nitric acid (sp. gr. 1.42) and equal volume of distilled water: at room temperature place a drop of test acid (each drop to be 1/16 inch minimum diameter) on three different places on the gold plated surface. The drops shall remain on the insignia for not less than one minute. A minimum of two of these spots shall withstand this test.

4.6.9 Test for screw post. The thumb nut or plate shall be assembled on the screw post during which the operation of screw threads shall be observed to determine compliance with the requirements specified in 3.8.3.

4.6.10 Test for baked enamel. Draw a knife edge across the face side of the specimen making four parallel scores one-sixteenth inch apart. Repeat this process, drawing the knife edge this time perpendicular to the previously scored lines, making small blocks in the finish. The finish shall then be examined to determine compliance with 3.9.5.

4.6.11 Acetone test for baked enamel. The enamelled surface shall be wiped five times with a piece of cotton saturated with acetone. The cotton shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.9.5.

4.6.12 Test for integral prongs. The prong to be tested shall be positioned in a fixture or jig which allows no movement of the insignia and positions the prong on an angle of 30 degrees above the horizontal. A vertical load of 10 lbs. shall be applied to the upper portion of each prong. The prongs shall be examined to determine compliance with 3.8.2.

4.6.13 Direct micro thickness test for copper plating. Copper plating thickness shall be determined in accordance with method 521 of FED-STD-151. Results shall be evaluated to determine compliance with 3.9.5.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2)

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Unit packaging.

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5.1.1.1.1 Army ROTC grade insignia. Twelve insignia of one grade and finish only for Private, Private First Class, Corporal, Sergeant or six insignia of one grade only for the remaining grades shall be equally spaced on a 5 inch by 3-1/2 inch, white sulfite card a minimum of 0.011 inch thick and wrapped in not less than three thicknesses of anti-tarnish paper having a minimum basis weight of not less than 12 pounds per ream or inserted into a snugfitting polyethylene film bag. The polyethylene film shall be a minimum of 0.002 inch thick and all seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. Prior to or during closure excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.1.2 Army cap insignia. Ten Army cap insignia of one type only shall be mounted on a white sulfite board card measuring approximately 6 1/2 inches by 5 inches and not less than 0.011 inch thick. Each card shall then be packaged in a snug-fitting transparent polyethylene bag. The polyethylene film shall not be less than 0.002 inch thick. all seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.1.3 Branch of service insignia. Twenty branch of service insignia of one type only shall be mounted on a white sulfite board card measuring approximately 6-1/2 inches by 5 inches and not less than 0.011 inch thick. Each card shall then be packaged in a snug fitting transparent polyethylene bag. The polyethylene film shall be not less than 0.002 inch thick. All seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.1.4 Air Force rank insignia. Two Air Force rank insignia of one type and size only shall be mounted on a 3 inch by 4 inch white sulfite board card having a minimum thickness of 0.011 inch thick. Each card shall then be packaged in a snug-fitting transparent polyethylene bag. The polyethylene film shall be not less than 0.002 inch thick. All seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. Prior to or during the heat sealing operation excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.1.5 Air Force grade insignia. Two Air Force ROTC or JROTC grade insignia of one type for grades Airman thru Sergeant shall be mounted on a white sulfite board card 2 inches by 3 inches and not less than 0.011 inch thick. Two Air Force ROTC or JROTC grade insignia of one type for grades Staff Sergeant thru Master Sergeant shall be mounted on a white sulfite board card 3 inches by 3 inches and not less than 0.011 inch thick.

5.1.1.1.6 Army rank insignia and Air Force cap insignia. Two Army rank insignia (one pair) of one type only or one Air Force cap insignia of one type only shall be mounted on a white sulfite card measuring three inches square and not less than 0.011 inch thick. The size of the mounting card for the insignia, Garrison cap, basic course, ROTC, Air Force shall be 2 1/2 inches square. Each card shall be packaged in a snug-fitting transparent polyethylene bag. The

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polyethylene shall be not less than 0.002 inch thick. All seams and closures shall be affected by heat sealing. prior to or during the heat sealing operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled.

5.1.1.2 Intermediate packaging. Two hundred branch of service insignia, rank insignia, Air Force grade insignia or one hundred cap or hat insignia of one type only shall be packaged in a set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4 of PPP-B-676. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. When plastic backing plates are procured with the insignia, one hundred plates of one type only shall be arranged on edge in two rows of fifty each in a set-up paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 1, 2 or 3 of PPP-B-676. A divider made of the same material as the box shall be positioned vertically between the rows. Box closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.1.3 Army ROTC grade insignia. Twenty unit packages of one grade and finish only shall be packaged in a snug-fitting paperboard box conforming to type I, variety 1, class A, style 4, of PPP-B-676. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification.

5.1.2 Level C. Insignia shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against deterioration and damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving station for immediate use or controlled humidity storage. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, C or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Insignia packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to class weather resistant, V3s or V3c of PPP-B-636. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Insignia packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard box conforming to type CF or SF, class domestic, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. closure shall be in accordance with the appendix of the container specification. The weight of the contents of each shipping container shall not exceed the size and weight limitations of the container specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Insignia packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packaged in a manner to assure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rates for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with the rules and regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

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5.2.4 Commercial. Insignia shall be packaged in accordance with the applicable requirements of ASTM-D-3951.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM-D-3951, as applicable. Except unit package marking may be printed on the reverse of the mounting card provided the printing is continuous and is legible through the bag.

5.3.1 Marking for cleaning. Marking for cleaning of gold plated items. To clean rub gently with a soft, dry cloth. Do not clean with a chemically treated cloth or abrasive.

5.4 Palletization. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be palletized in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Palletized loads shall be uniform in size and quantities to the greatest extent possible. If the container is of a size which does not conform to any of the pallet patterns specified in MIL-STD-147, the pallet pattern used shall first be approved by the contracting officer.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Insignia covered by this specification are intended to be worn by ROTC and JROTC personnel to indicate the wearer is a member of a particular service or has attained a particular rank.

6.2 Ordering data.

6.2.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Title, number and date of the applicable specification sheet (see 2.1 and 3.1).
c. When a standard sample will not be furnished (see 3.3).
d. When a first article is not required (see 3.4).
e. Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
f. When palletization is required (see 5.4).

6.3 Samples. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 First article. When a first article inspection is required, the item should be a first article sample or it may be a standard production item from the contractor's current inventory as specified in 4.4. The first article should consist of one completed insignia set. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements

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for examinations, approval of first article test results and disposition of first articles. Solicitations should provide that the Government reserves the right to waive the requirement for samples for first article inspection to those bidders offering a product which has been previously acquired or tested by the Government, and that bidders offering such products, who wish to rely on such production or test, must furnish evidence with the bid that prior Government approval is presently appropriate for the pending contract.

6.5 Subject term (key word) listing.

Branch of service
Copper base alloy
Electronic fusion
Garrison cap
Grade
Insignia
Rank
ROTC and JROTC personnel
Service cap

6.6 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks or vertical lines are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH
Air Force - 11
Navy - NU

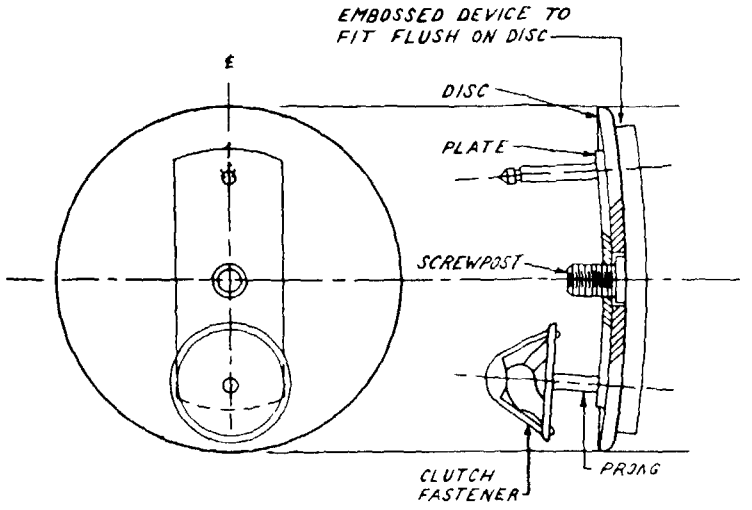
Review activities:
Air Force - 82,99
Navy - CG, MC
DLA - CT

User activity:
Air Force - 45

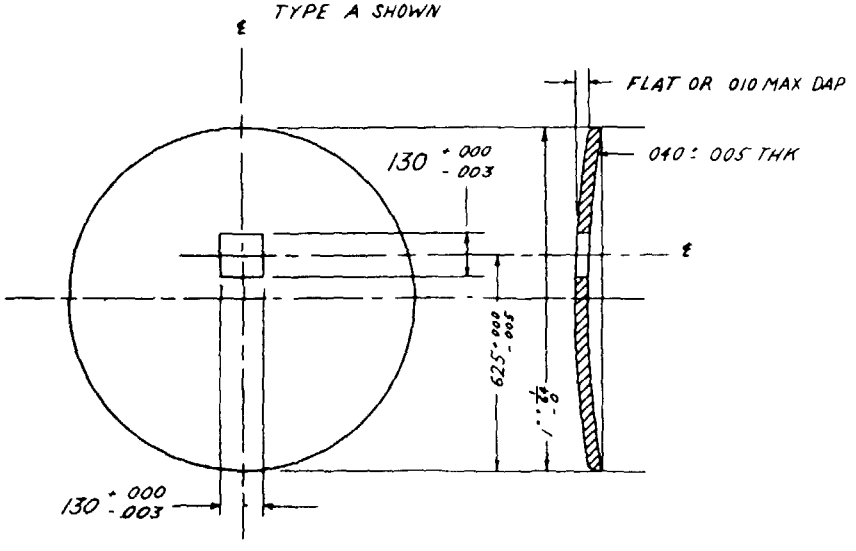
Preparing activity:
Army - IH

(Project No. 8455 - 0227)

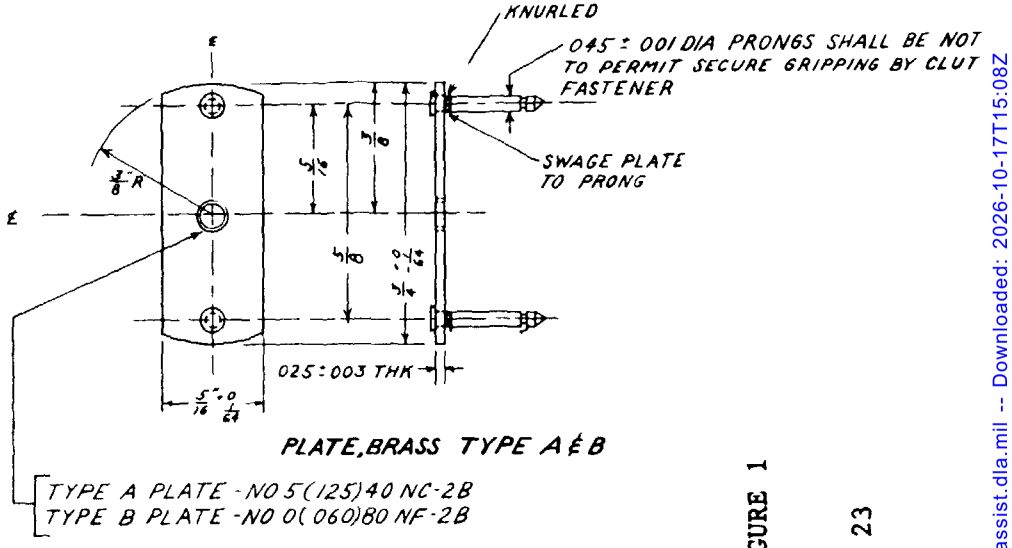
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TYPICAL ASSEMBLY
TYPE A SHOWN

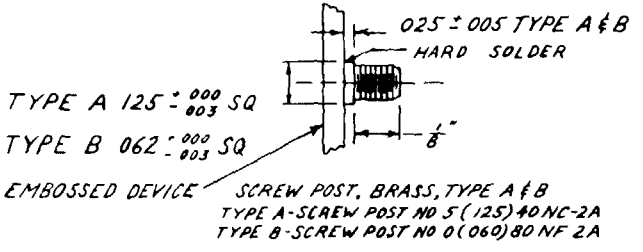


DISC, RED BRASS
TYPE B



PLATE, BRASS TYPE A & B

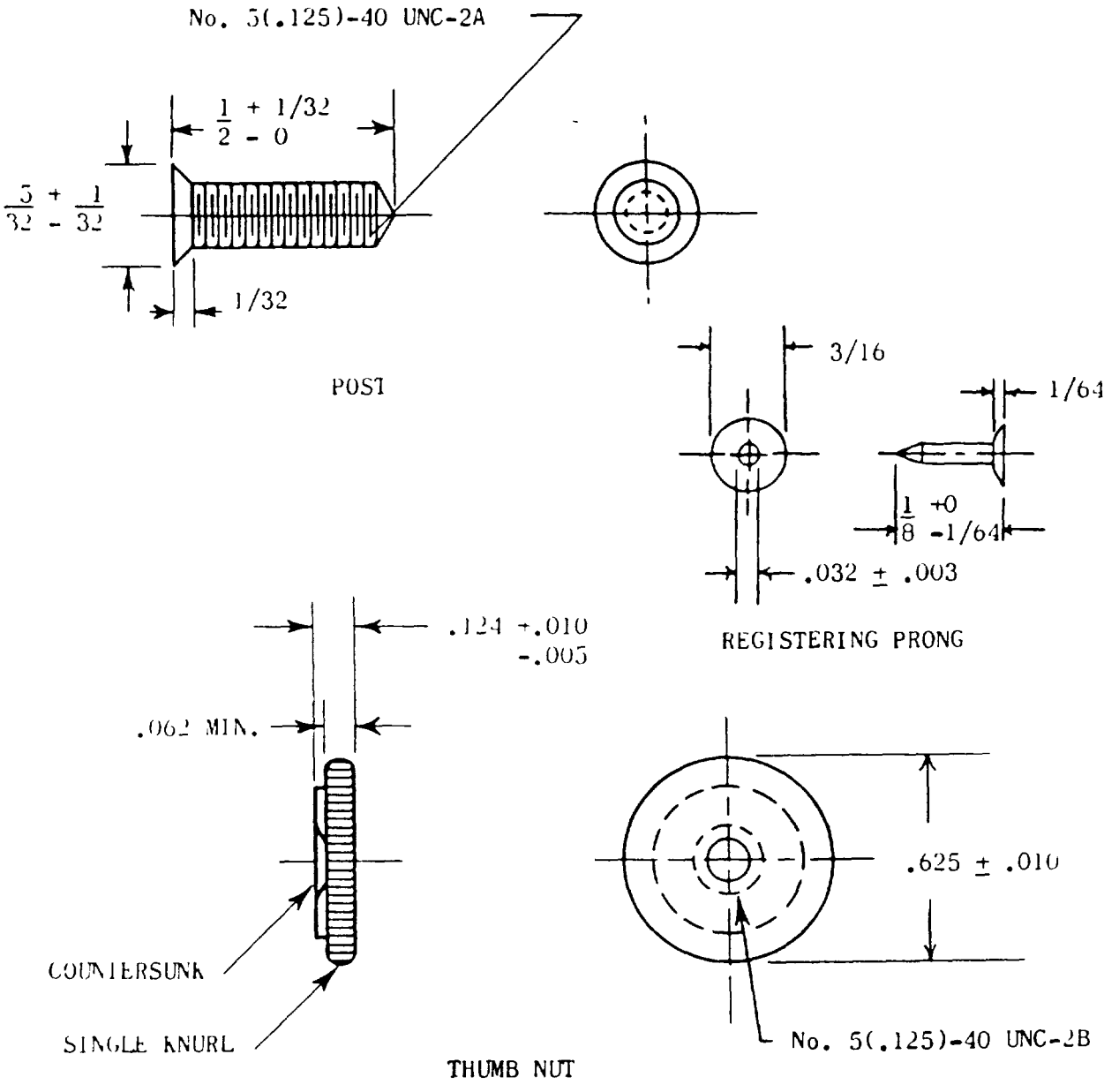
TYPE A PLATE - NO 5 (125) 40 NC-2B
TYPE B PLATE - NO 0 (060) 80 NF-2B



SCREW POST, BRASS, TYPE A & B
TYPE A - SCREW POST NO 5 (125) 40 NC-2A
TYPE B - SCREW POST NO 0 (060) 80 NF 2A

FIGURE 1

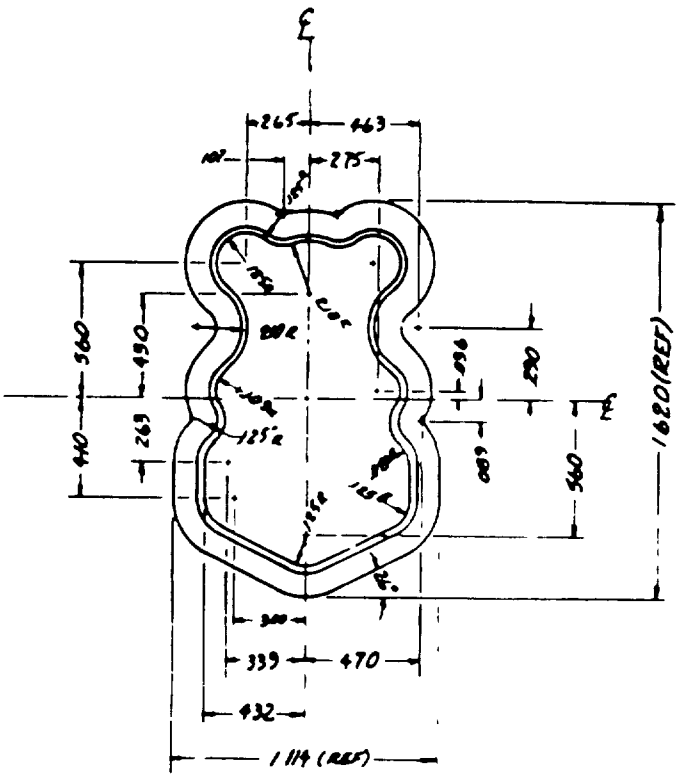
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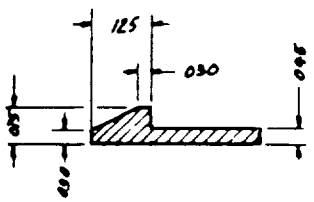


NOTE: Dimensions are in inches.

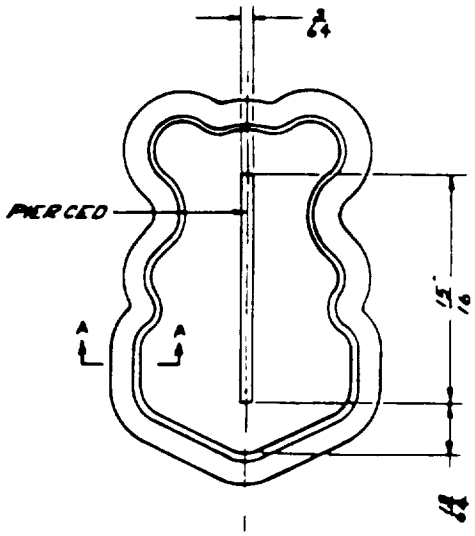
FIGURE 2

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SECTION A-A
SCALE 4 X 1

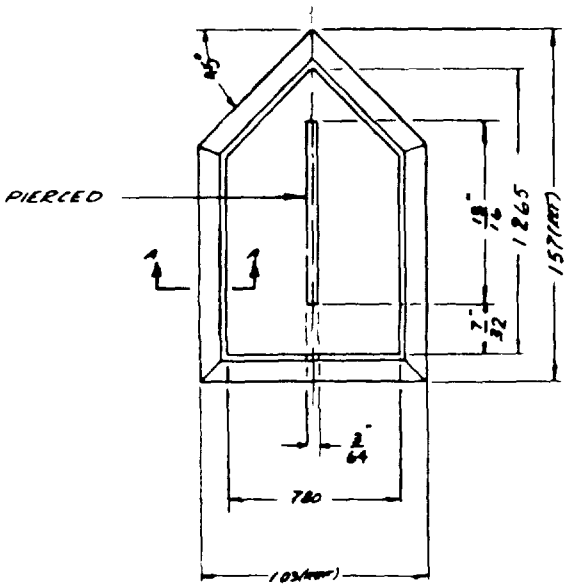


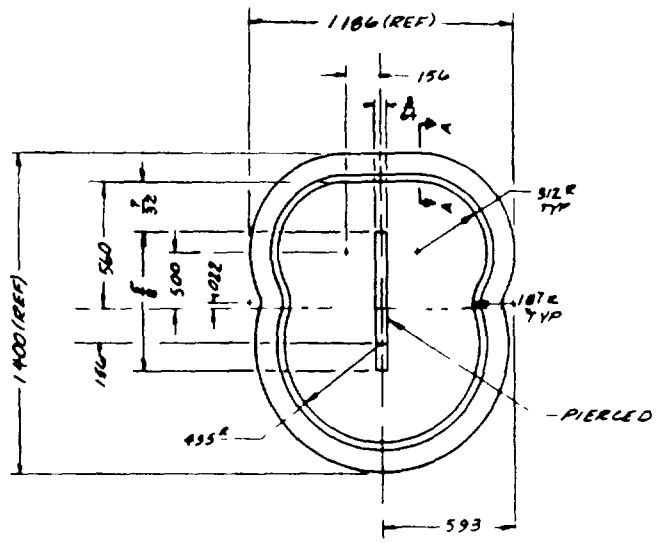
UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED
TOLERANCES SHALL BE AS FOLLOWS
FRACTIONS ± 1/64
DECIMALS ± 005

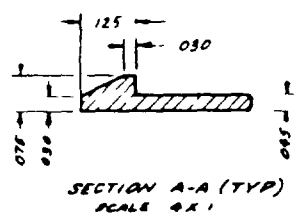
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FIGURE 3

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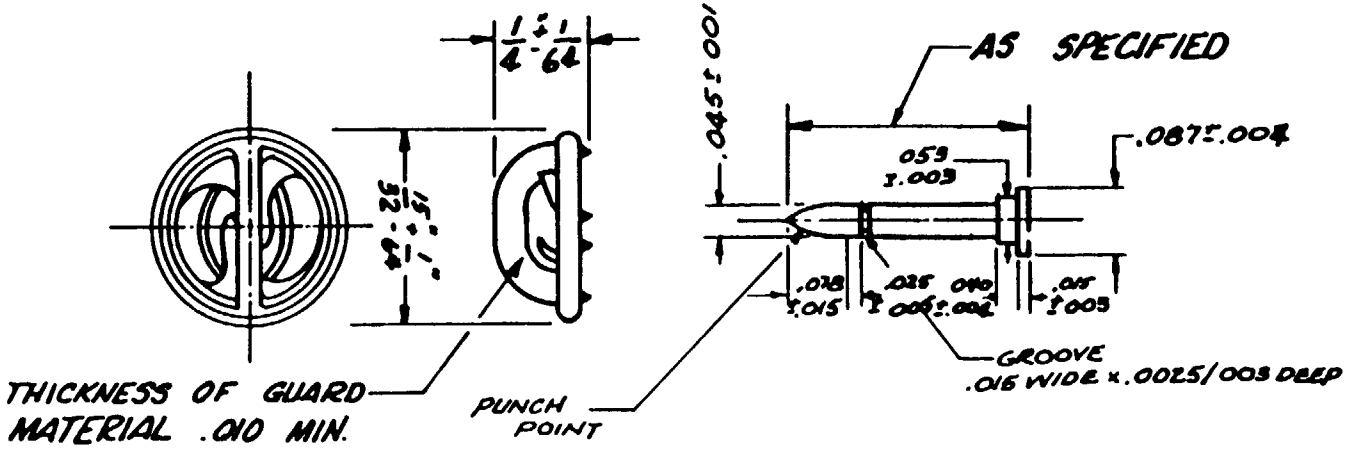


UNLESS OTHERWISE SPECIFIED TOLERANCES SHALL BE AS FOLLOWS
FRACTIONS ± 1/64
DECIMALS ± 005

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FIGURE 4

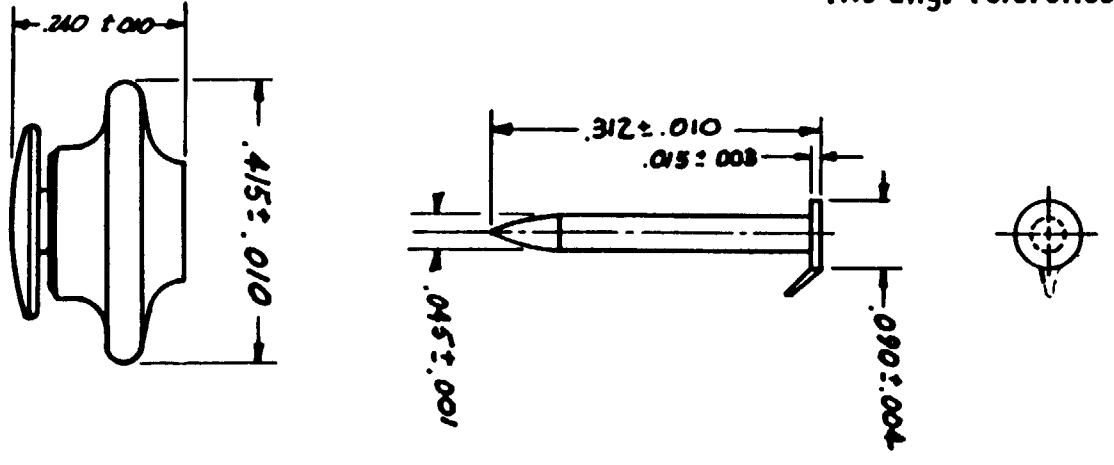
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CLUTCH PRONG

FIGURE 5

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FLAT BALL TYPE CLUTCH PRONG WITH PICK

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-I-11132H	Insignia; Branch of Service, Grade, Rank, Garrisc Cap, and Service Cap, ROTC and JROTC Personnel, AR & AF

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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